



Evernote update for Windows

The new update for Evernote allows you to work more effectively. The new powerful feature 'Activity Stream' makes it easier than ever before. <http://dgit.in/NErNCM>

RIM to split into two?

According to a British newspaper, RIM is considering breaking up into two divisions: handset and messaging network division.

The best apps from the non-iOS eco-systems

This month we look at the best app for Windows Phone and Android

Windows Phone

Windows Phone has been under a lot of flak for a long time for not having enough apps in their ecosystem. Analysts are not too convinced about the quality of those apps either. When they launched in India in October 2011 they were at 35,000 apps and now there are more than 1,00,000 apps in the Windows Phone Marketplace. But coming back to quality, while the perception may not be completely baseless we did manage to find a few interesting apps.

Bookviser

Every platform these days has plenty of eBook readers, not only in the wild but also as part of the customisations that manufacturers implement on the plain vanilla base OS. Bookviser is a free eBook reader that offers a wide variety of features. First the basics - in terms of formats, it supports EPUB, FB2 and TXT. Apart from accessing your own book collection you can search and download public domain books from the likes of Project Gutenberg. The UI is pretty slick and provides easy access to last opened books. For every book the app intelligently manages to remember the page you were on. You have options to customise your reading experience by changing colour and font size. The page turn transitions and effects are not bad either. A few things such as word searches, annotations and dictionary look-ups could've been added



though. If you're looking for those features, another eBook app called Freda could be the app for you. The only trouble with Freda is that it's not very stable and till recently was a clunky app.

Rating: 4/5

PC Remote

Let's face it, most of us watch movies on our computers. And with screen sizes becoming larger by the day, who wouldn't want to sit back and enjoy a pseudo-theater experience? The only trouble is when you're away from the PC it becomes a pain when you need to pause



the movie for a call or lunge for the mouse when there's an explosion and your ears almost bleed. Of course we exaggerate, but we're pretty sure you get the idea. With PC remote you can essentially control your PC from your Phone. All you need is Wi-Fi and a server up and running on your machine.

Rating: 4.5/5

eBay

The eBay app is one of the better designed apps on the Windows Phone platform. Using the application, shoppers can browse through 6 million listings in the electronics, lifestyle, collectible and media categories. One of the coolest features is the toaster notifications for items under bidding and watched items. The eBay Explorer feature is perfect for shopaholics who aren't really looking for something specific and want to window shop. The page by page browsing mechanism is pretty nifty. The barcode scan however doesn't work at all. It scans all right, but when we tried looking up a few products using their barcodes, none showed up any results. We suspect it tries to look up the Universal Product Code (UPC) number on eBay, but which seller would bother to feed it in. You'll have better luck with the default Bing "vision" barcode scanner than this app, but sans this small niggle overall the eBay app is a nice app to have handy.

Rating: 3/5



IM+

OK let's get one thing out of the way at the outset - this is a bad app. Then why is it featured here? Because it's better than the rest of the free IM clients in the Windows Phone universe that let you use Gtalk on your phone. The app has all the standard features - pinning, tile notifications, toaster notifications, etc. - but you can enjoy them only if the app decides to work. It's not very dependable and signs you out at times. We'll be on the lookout for better clients. Until then, this app is your best bet.

Rating: 2/5

Android

The Google Play Store has grown steadily and boasts of more than 5,00,000 apps, including games, productivity apps, social and news apps along with utilities to enhance your smartphone experience. This month we bring you some